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Zachary Batist

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- Research data management
- Open research infrastructure
- Scientific software development
- Advocate for community-driven infrastructure
- Scholar of scientific practice
- Critical and feminist meta-research
- Bridging policy with real-world experiences
- Pan-disciplinary experience and outlook

CURRENT POSITION

2025 – **Postdoctoral Researcher**
Covid-19 Immunity Task Force Databank
Department of Epidemiology, Biostatistics and Occupational Health
School of Public and Global Health, McGill University
zackbatist.info/CITF-Postdoc

EDUCATION

2023 **PhD**, Faculty of Information, University of Toronto
Archaeological data work as continuous and collaborative practice

2014 **MA**, Department of Anthropology, McMaster University
Obsidian Circulation Networks in Southwest Asia and Anatolia: A Comparative Approach

2012 **BA**, Directed Interdisciplinary Studies, Carleton University

2009 **DEC**, Social Sciences, Dawson College

PAST POSITIONS

2018 – 2023 **Research Assistant**
E–CURATORS: Pervasive Digital Curation Activities, Objects and Infrastructures in Archaeological Research and Communication
Faculty of Information, University of Toronto

2016 – 2021 **Database Manager**
Stelida Naxos Archaeology Project

2007 – 2009 **Research Assistant**
Molecular Pharmacology Laboratory
Lady Davis Institute for Medical Research

RESEARCH OUTCOMES

JOURNAL ARTICLES

2025 Batist, Z. **Balancing situated and objective representations in archaeological fieldwork.** Advances in Archaeological Practice. 13(4):514-527.
DOI: 10.1017/aap.2025.10101.

2025 Batist, Z. **Locating creative agency in archaeological data work.**
Peer Community in Archaeology. DOI: 10.17613/8eqy4-n1m82.

2024 Batist, Z. **Does not compute! Accounting for social and situated experiences while integrating and analyzing obsidian sourcing data.** Archeologia e Calcolatori. (special issue comprising papers presented at ArcheoFOSS XVII). 35(2):47-54. DOI: 10.19282/ac.35.2.2024.06.

2024 Batist, Z. **On the Value of Informal Communication in Archaeological Data Work.** Open Archaeology. 10(1):20240014. DOI: 10.1515/opar-2024-0014.

2024 Batist, Z & Roe, J. **Open archaeology, open source? Collaborative practices in an emerging community of archaeological software engineers.** Internet Archaeology 67. DOI: 10.11141/ia.67.13. • GitHub: zackbatist/openarchaeo-collaboration.

2023 Batist, Z & Roe, J. **Open-archaeo: a resource for documenting archaeological software development practices.** Journal of Open Archaeology Data. 11(9):1-7. DOI: 10.5334/joad.111.

2021 Batist, Z, Masters, V, Torma, TC, Ferris, N, Huvila, I, Ross, S, Carter, WM & Dallas, C. **Figurations of Digital Archaeological Practice in Two Mediterranean Fieldwork Projects.** Open Archaeology (Special Issue on Archaeological Practice on Shifting Grounds) 7(1):1731-1755. DOI: 10.1515/opar-2020-0217.

2021 Contreras, D, Batist, Z, Zogheib, C & Carter, T. **Matching Pragmatic Lithic Analysis and Proper Data Architecture: The QuARI R Shiny Database Interface.** Advances in Archaeological Practice 9(4):299-311. DOI: 10.1017/aap.2021.11.

2017 Carter, T, Batist, Z, Campeau, K, Garfinkel, Y & Streit, K. **Investigating Pottery Neolithic Socio-Economic "Regression" in the Southern Levant: Characterising Obsidian Consumption at Sha'ar Hagolan (N. Israel).** Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports 15:305-317. DOI: 10.1016/j.jasrep.2017.08.016.

2014 Freund, KP & Batist, Z. **Sardinian Obsidian Circulation and Early Maritime Navigation in the Neolithic as Shown through Social Network Analysis.** Journal of Island and Coastal Archaeology 9(3):364-380. DOI: 10.1080/15564894.2014.881937.

2009 Loignon, M, Miao, W, Hu, L, Bouchard, A, Bismar, TA, Scrivens, PJ, Mann, K, Basik, M, Fiset, PO, Batist, Z & Batist, G. **Frequent Nrf2 depletion due to Cul3 overexpression in breast cancer is associated with sensitivity to carcinogens, oxidative stress and chemotherapy.** Molecular Cancer Therapeutics 8(8):2432-2440. DOI: 10.1158/1535-7163.MCT-08-1186.

Articles in Progress

In progress Batist, Z, Ouellet, M., Khezri, S., Murphy, T., Noza, A., Abbasgholizadeh-Rahimi, S., Bourque, G. & Buckeridge, D. **LLM-assisted topic modelling of Canadian COVID-19 Immunity Task Force data sharing operations.** BMC Medical Informatics and Decision Making. https://zackbatist.info/CITF-emails/topic-modelling/

In progress Bernier, A., Baltzan, I., Wey, T., Batist, Z. & Fortier, I. **Data Governance in Longitudinal Mother-Child Cohorts: An Empirical Assessment of the Canadian ReACH Studies.**

In progress Khezri, S., Murphy, T., **Batist, Z.**, Noza, A., Ouellet, M., Wey, T., Nechba, A., Wissa, R., CITF Contributors & Buckeridge, D. **The CITF Databank: A harmonized dataset of SARS-CoV-2 immunity data from Canadian research studies.**

In review Farahnak, F., W.S. El-Deiry, Y.A. Lussier, R. Kurzrock, S. Magidi, C. Bresson, S.A. Enger, J. Liu, J. Bar, J.L. Warner, T. Meissner, E. Rubin, J. Rueter, H. Gaddipati, M. Kulkarni, Z. Chen, S. Limaye, R. Elsey, B.M. Rubenstein, A.M. Joshua, H.O. Al-Shamsi, K.M. Musallam, F. Wunder, J. Raynaud, G. Berchem, M. Gantenbein, A. Al Omari, S. Dermime, H. Abdel-Razeq, P. Saintigny, A. Cervantes, R.R. Reddel, A.T. Aref, J. Martin-Liberal, C. Lázaro, D.C. Romera, M. Sekacheva, R. Berger, C.S. Pramesh, I. Berindan-Neagoe, E. Girda, A. Piris-Gimenez, C.J. Farhangfar, M.E. Salem, R. Dienstmann, R. Salazar, N.Z. Frankel, **Z. Batist**, Y. Quintana & G. Batist. **Worldwide Innovative Network (WIN) Consortium: Building a Common Global Cancer Database** Nature Reviews in Clinical Oncology.

In progress Batist, Z., Julie Lund & Isak Roalkvam **Bibliometric analysis of Viking Age Research.**

In progress Batist, Z. & Shirin Abbasinejad Enger. **Positive mentorship in the history of radiology.**

BOOK CONTRIBUTIONS

2018 Graham, S, Gupta, N, Smith, J, Angourakis, A, Reinhard, A, Ellenberger, K, Batist, Z, Rivard, J, Marwick, B, Carter, WM, Compton, B, Blades, R, Wood, C & Nobles, G. **The Open Digital Archaeology Textbook.** eCampus Ontario. o-date.github.io
🎗 Award for Outstanding Work in Digital Archaeology, Archaeological Institute of America

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

In review Batist, Z. **Data Management is People Management: On Abstraction of Data and Labor in Archaeological Projects.** Data and Technology Politics in Archaeology Workshop. GitHub: zackbatist/data-tech-poli-arch. • zackbatist.info/data-tech-poli-arch

2022 Batist, Z. **Documenting archaeological knowledge construction as information practices.** Human History and Digital Future. Proceedings of the 46th Conference on Computer Applications and Quantitative Methods in Archaeology. Tübingen University Press. DOI: 10.15496/publikation-94869.

OPEN-SOURCE SOFTWARE

2020 – 2021 **Queryable Artefact Record Interface (QuARI)**
A database interface designed to facilitate the irregular, iterative, and non-linear workflows that are commonly employed in lithic analysis. GitHub: zackbatist/QuARI.

2025 – present **qc-atelier**
A series of utilities to support the Qualitative Coding software package.
GitHub: zackbatist/CITF-Postdoc.

OPEN DATASETS

2018 – present **open-archaeo** A comprehensive list of open source archaeological software and resources. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.8299651. • GitHub: zackbatist/open-archaeo. • open-archaeo.info

2014 – 2017 **The Database of Obsidian Sourcing Studies (DObsiSS)** A listing of chemically characterized archaeological obsidian, compiled from published journal articles, excavation reports, conference papers and other scholarly records. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.55848. • GitHub: zackbatist/DObsiSS. • zackbatist.info/DObsiSS

OTHER OPEN INITIATIVES

2025 – present **Digital Archaeology Maintainathon** A week-long drive to encourage maintenance of code and data, and to help instill good para-coding practices among archaeological researchers. GitHub: sslarch/maintainathon. • https://sslarch.github.io/maintainathon/

2024 – present **Diamond Open Archaeology** A listing of diamond open access archaeology journals. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.15026607. • GitHub: open-archaeo/diamond. • diamond.open-archaeo.info

AWARDS & HONORS

2014 **Robert P. Wolff Thesis Prize**
Society for Philosophy & Culture, McMaster University

2012 **Dean's Honour List**
Carleton University

2012 **Michael Kelway Oliver Scholarship**
Carleton University

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

MAJOR GRANTS

2019 – 2021 **SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship**. Archaeological data curation as continuous and collaborative practice. Award ID: 752-2019-2233. ($20,000)

MINOR GRANTS

2019 **Research Travel Grant** ($500)
Faculty of Arts and Science, University of Toronto

2017 **Joseph and Maria Shaw Graduate Student Travel Award** ($500)
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto

2015 **McMaster University Travel Scholarship for OpenCon 2015** ($2500)
McMaster University Library, McMaster University

2015 **Edith M. Wightman Travel Scholarship** ($1000)
School of Graduate Studies, McMaster University

2015 **Travel Assistance Grant** ($500)
School of Graduate Studies, McMaster University

2015 **Graduate Student Travel Award** ($120)
Archaeological Institute of America

2014 **McMaster University Travel Scholarship for OpenCon 2014** ($2500, declined)
McMaster University Library, McMaster University

2011 **Full Tuition Scholarship** (declined)
Digital Humanities Summer Institute, University of Victoria

TEACHING

TEACHING ASSISTANT

2020 **Curatorial Practice** (MSL 2000)
Faculty of Information, University of Toronto

2017 – 2020 **Representing, Documenting, and Accessing the Cultural Record** (INF 1321)
Faculty of Information, University of Toronto

2017 **Information Policy, Regulation and Law** (INF 2181)
Faculty of Information, University of Toronto

2016 **Archaeology and Popular Culture** (ANTH 2PC3)
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

2014 – 2015 **World Archaeology** (ANTH 2WA3E)
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

2012, 2015 **Introduction to Anthropology: Identity, Race and Power** (ANTH 1AB3E)
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

2013 **Introduction to Anthropology: Sex, Food and Death** (ANTH 1AA3)
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

WORKSHOPS & SHORT COURSES

2022 March **Using Qualitative Data Analysis Software**
The Ethnography Lab Methods Café: Software in Ethnographic Research Methods
Department of Anthropology, University of Toronto

2018 January **Designing and Implementing Relational Databases**
Archaeological Information Interest Group
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto
GitHub: zackbatist/archaeo-db-workshop.

PRESENTATIONS

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2026 March **Investigating archaeological information commons as coordinated, collective and community-driven action**
Digital Archaeology and Heritage Lab Digital Lunch Series
Department of Archaeology, University of York

2025 December **Archaeological Data Work in Practice**
Digital Heritage Seminar
Instructed by Piraye Hacıgüzeller
Antwerp Cultural Heritage Sciences (ARCHES), University of Antwerp

2025 October **Open Data in Practice**
INF 649: Digital Curation
Instructed by Ilja Frissen
School of Information Studies, McGill University

2025 April **Articulating data harmonization as pragmatic, collaborative experiences**
McGill Clinical and Health Information Research Group
School of Population and Global Health, McGill University
zackbatist.info/CITF-Postdoc/MCHI-2025

2024 November **Curating archaeological research data in practice, from the field to the archive**
INF 649: Digital Curation
Instructed by Ilja Frissen
School of Information Studies, McGill University

2024 October — **Exploring collaborative practices in archaeological software development**
A coffee talk for Dr. Jean-Baptiste Poline and colleagues
Neuro Data Science ORIGAMI Lab, McGill University

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 June — Batist, Z. **Where do we draw the line? On legitimate uses of AI and open information commons, and commitment to community values.** Paper to be presented at the 2026 Implementing New Knowledge Environments (INKE) Gathering. Canadian Society for Digital Humanities / Digital Humanities Summer Institute, Université de Montréal. GitHub: zackbatist/inke-2026. • zackbatist.info/inke-2026

2026 April — Batist, Z, Roalkvam, I & Lund, J. **A Protocol for Analyzing Citational Practice in Viking Age Archaeology.** Paper presented at Citational Politics and Practices in Viking Age Archaeology and Beyond. Department of Archaeology, Conservation and History, University of Oslo. zackbatist.info/BibVik/analytical-protocol-slides

2026 April — Roe, J., Batist, Z, Yates, J.A.F. & Titolo, A. **archaeo.social and archaeo.dev: decentralised, collective digital infrastructure for archaeologists.** Poster presented at the 53rd Computer Applications and Quantitative Methods in Archaeology Conference (CAA 2026). Vienna, Austria. GitHub: archaeo-social/caa26_archaeo-dev.

2023 December — Batist, Z. **Does not compute! Accounting for social and situated experiences while integrating and analyzing obsidian sourcing data.** Paper presented at ArcheoFOSS XVII – Open Science and Archaeology: Archiving the Knowledge. Department of Historical Studies, University of Turin.

2023 February — Batist, Z. **Documenting the collaborative commitments that support data sharing within archaeological project collectives.** Paper presented at Digital Archaeology Bern 2023. Bern Computational and Digital Archaeology lab, University of Bern. GitHub: zackbatist/DAB23.

2021 June — Batist, Z & Roe, J. **Open archaeology: a survey of collaborative software engineering in archaeological research.** Paper presented at the 49th Computer Applications and Quantitative Methods in Archaeology Conference (CAA 2021). Limassol, Cyprus (Virtual). GitHub: zackbatist/caa2021-openarchaeo.

2019 September — Batist, Z. **Distributing Knowledge Of Digital Workflows Via Workshops And Support Groups.** Lightning talk presented at Our Networks, Re: Infrastructure. Toronto.

2019 October — Batist, Z. **Untangling and extending the discursive relations mediated by archaeological data through grounded research.** Paper presented at On shifting grounds – the study of archaeological practices in a changing world, COST-Arkwork and the Department of History and Archaeology, University of Crete. Rethymno, Crete.

2018 April — Batist, Z. **Documenting archaeological knowledge construction as socially-embedded information practices.** Paper presented at PhD Research Days 2018, Faculty of Information, University of Toronto. Toronto, Ontario.

2018 March — Batist, Z. **Documenting archaeological knowledge construction as distributed information practices.** Paper presented at the 46th Computer Applications and Quantitative Methods in Archaeology Conference (CAA 2018). Tübingen, Germany. DOI: 10.15496/publikation-87754.

2017 May — Batist, Z & Dallas, C. **A view from the bridge: human- and thing-centred approaches to research practice, disciplinary discourse and local engagement with the archaeological record.** Paper presented at TAG (North America) 2017 - The Medium is the Message: Media and Mediation in Archaeology. Toronto, Ontario.

2017 March — Carter, T, Campeau, K, Batist, Z, Garfinkel, Y, Rosenberg, D, Rowan, Y & Streit, K. **Social Interaction at Distance Over the Long Term: Obsidian Sourcing from the Southern Levant (9th – 4th millennia cal BC).** Paper presented at the Society for American Archaeology 82nd Annual Meeting. Vancouver, British Columbia.

2017 January — Batist, Z. **Identifying Obsidian Procurement Habits during the Pre-Pottery Neolithic in the Levant using Network Analysis.** Poster presented at the Archaeological Institute of America 118th Annual Meeting. Toronto, Ontario.

2015 January — Batist, Z. **The Database of Obsidian Sourcing Studies (DObsiSS): Using Git for Collaborative Management of Archaeological Data.** Poster presented at the American Archaeological Institute 116th Annual Meeting. New Orleans, Louisiana.

2014 March — Batist, Z. **An Examination of Obsidian Circulation Patterns in Terms of Relational and Geographical Distance in Southwest Asia and Anatolia from the Epi-Palaeolithic to Chalcolithic Periods (14000 – 5700 B.P.).** Paper presented at Archaeological Sciences and the Ancient Mediterranean Environment. The Archaeological Centre, University of Toronto.

2014 January — Batist, Z. **Using Network Analysis to Examine Relative Resource Procurement Strategies in Anatolia and Southwest Asia from the Epipaleolithic to Chalcolithic Periods (14,000 – 5700 BP).** Paper presented at the American Archaeological Institute 115th Annual Meeting. Chicago, Illinois.

2013 November — Freund, KP & Batist, Z. **Tracking the Circulation of Sardinian Obsidian using Network Analysis: Lithic Procurement, Cultural Interaction, and Early Maritime Navigation in the Neolithic.** Paper presented at Networks of maritime connectivity in the ancient Mediterranean: Structure, continuity, and change over the longue durée. The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto. Toronto, Ontario.

2013 September — Batist, Z. **Using network analysis to examine obsidian assemblage variability in Anatolia and Southwest Asia from the Epi-Palaeolithic to Chalcolithic periods (14000 – 5700 BP).** Paper presented at The Future of Historical Network Research Conference. Historical Network Research, University of Hamburg. Hamburg, Germany.

2012 March — Batist, Z. **Eat, Drink and Be Networked: Feasting and Bronze Age Networks.** Invited panelist at the Colloquium on Digital History and the Transnational History of Nursing. Department of History, Carleton University. Ottawa, Ontario.

OUTREACH

2022 – present — **Personal blog**, zackbatist.info/posts
Posts about my research and professional activities

ACADEMIC SERVICE & AFFILIATIONS

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

2026 – present **Founder and Coordinator**, Digital Archaeology Maintainathon
An event dedicated to improving archaeological research software and celebrating the often-overlooked work of software maintenance.

2025 Summer **Interim Coordinator** (and member since 2019), Scientific Scripting Languages in Archaeology Special Interest Group (sslarch.github.io)
Computer Applications in Archaeology

2018 – present **Founder and Maintainer**, open-archaeo.info
Index of open source archaeological software and resources

2022 – present **Community Moderator**, archaeo.social
Mastodon instance and social media collective for archaeology

2022 **Peer Mentor**, UofT Coders Peer Mentorship Program
UofT Coders, University of Toronto

2017 – 2021 **Founder and Coordinator**, Archaeological Information Interest Group
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto

2013 – 2014 **Webmaster**, Nexus: The Canadian Student Journal of Anthropology
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

COMMITTEES

2019 – 2020 **Graduate Student Union Faculty Representative**
Faculty of Information Doctoral Student Association, University of Toronto

2016 – 2019 **Tech Fund Committee Member and Coordinator**
Faculty of Information Doctoral Student Association, University of Toronto

2013 – 2014 **Graduate Student Association Faculty Representative**
Faculty of Social Sciences, McMaster University

CONFERENCE & PANEL ORGANIZER

2026 April **Citational Politics and Practices in Viking Age Archaeology and Beyond**
Co-organized with Julie Lund & Isak Roalkvam
Department of Archaeology, Conservation and History, University of Oslo
Discussion about methodological challenges in bibliometric analysis, aspects of reflexivity in Viking Age archaeology, and how computational methods can be leveraged to conduct meaningful meta-research. zackbatist.info/BibVik/workshop

2014 **Second Annual Interdisciplinary Colloquium**
Co-organized with Priscilla Medeiros
Faculty of Social Sciences, McMaster University

INTEREST GROUPS

2018 – 2022 UofT Coders (uoftcoders.github.io)
University of Toronto

2018 – 2019 Digitality Reading Group
University of Toronto

2017 – 2019 Archaeological Theory Interest Group
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto

2017 – 2021 Archaeological Information Interest Group
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto

CERTIFICATIONS

- The Carpentries Instructor Training

REVIEWER

- Open Information Science
- Computer Applications in Archaeology
- Peer Community in Archaeology
- Advances in Archaeological Practice

LANGUAGES

English Mother tongue

French Basic reading and writing